

Table of Contents

State/Territory Name: District of Columbia

State Plan Amendment (SPA) #: 25-0013

This file contains the following documents in the order listed:

- 1) Approval Letter
- 2) Summary Form (with 179-like data)
- 3) Approved SPA Pages

DC - Submission Package - DC2025MS00030 - (DC-25-0013) - Eligibility

[Summary](#) [Reviewable Units](#) [Versions](#) [Correspondence Log](#) [Analyst Notes](#) [Approval Letter](#) [Transaction Logs](#) [News](#) [Related Actions](#)

DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & HUMAN SERVICES
Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services
Medicaid and CHIP Operations Group
601 E. 12th St., Room 355
Kansas City, MI 64106



Center for Medicaid & CHIP Services

November 18, 2025

Melisa Byrd
Director
Department of Health Care Finance
441 4th Street, NW
Washington, DC 20001

Re: Approval of State Plan Amendment DC-25-0013

Dear Melisa Byrd,

On August 21, 2025, the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) received District of Columbia State Plan Amendment (SPA) DC-25-0013, in which DC proposed to: discontinue coverage of the optional eligibility group serving individuals with MAGI-based income above 133 percent of the federal poverty level (FPL); and reduce the income eligibility standard of its mandatory eligibility group serving parents and other caretaker relatives from 216 percent of the FPL to 133 percent of the FPL.

We approve District of Columbia State Plan Amendment (SPA) DC-25-0013 with an effective date(s) of January 01, 2026.

If you have any questions regarding this amendment, please contact Taneka Rivera at (410) 786-9502 or via email Taneka.Rivera@cms.hhs.gov.

Sincerely,

Nicole McKnight

On Behalf of Courtney Miller, MCOG
Director

Center for Medicaid & CHIP Services

DC - Submission Package - DC2025MS0003O - (DC-25-0013) - Eligibility

- Summary
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- Versions
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- Analyst Notes
- Approval Letter
- Transaction Logs
- News
- Related Actions

Submission - Summary

MEDICAID | Medicaid State Plan | Eligibility | DC2025MS0003O | DC-25-0013

CMS-10434 OMB 0938-1188

Package Header

Package ID	DC2025MS0003O	SPA ID	DC-25-0013
Submission Type	Official	Initial Submission Date	8/21/2025
Approval Date	11/18/2025	Effective Date	N/A
Superseded SPA ID	N/A		

State Information

State/Territory Name:	District of Columbia	Medicaid Agency Name:	Department of Health Care Finance
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Submission Component

- State Plan Amendment
- Medicaid
- CHIP

Submission - Summary

MEDICAID | Medicaid State Plan | Eligibility | DC2025MS0003O | DC-25-0013

Package Header

Package ID	DC2025MS0003O	SPA ID	DC-25-0013
Submission Type	Official	Initial Submission Date	8/21/2025
Approval Date	11/18/2025	Effective Date	N/A
Superseded SPA ID	N/A		

SPA ID and Effective Date

SPA ID DC-25-0013

Reviewable Unit	Proposed Effective Date	Superseded SPA ID
Mandatory Eligibility Groups	1/1/2026	DC-23-0002
Parents and Other Caretaker Relatives	1/1/2026	DC-13-0007
Optional Eligibility Groups	1/1/2026	DC-22-0014
Individuals above 133% FPL under Age 65	1/1/2026	DC-22-0014

Page Number of the Superseded Plan Section or Attachment (If Applicable):

Submission - Summary

MEDICAID | Medicaid State Plan | Eligibility | DC2025MS0003O | DC-25-0013

Package Header

Package ID	DC2025MS0003O	SPA ID	DC-25-0013
Submission Type	Official	Initial Submission Date	8/21/2025
Approval Date	11/18/2025	Effective Date	N/A
Superseded SPA ID	N/A		

Executive Summary

Summary Description Including Goals and Objectives Beginning on January 1, 2026, the District of Columbia proposes to: (1) discontinue Medicaid eligibility for adults under age sixty-five (65) with income above one hundred thirty three percent (133%) of the federal poverty level (FPL); and (2) decrease the income eligibility requirement of parents and other caretaker relatives to one hundred thirty three percent (133%) of the FPL. The District’s Health Benefit Exchange will contemporaneously offer eligibility for benefits through a Basic Health Plan and a Qualified Health Plan in which the impacted eligibility groups will be transitioned.

Federal Budget Impact and Statute/Regulation Citation

Federal Budget Impact

	Federal Fiscal Year	Amount
First	2026	\$-102068847
Second	2027	\$-139085806

Federal Statute / Regulation Citation

42 CFR § 435.218
42 CFR § 435.110

Supporting documentation of budget impact is uploaded (optional).

Name	Date Created	
No items available		

Submission - Summary

MEDICAID | Medicaid State Plan | Eligibility | DC2025MS0003O | DC-25-0013

Package Header

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Submission Type	Official	Initial Submission Date	8/21/2025
Approval Date	11/18/2025	Effective Date	N/A
Superseded SPA ID	N/A		

Governor's Office Review

- ☐ No comment
- ☐ Comments received
- ☐ No response within 45 days
- ☒ Other

Describe D.C. Law 22-106 provides the authority that no longer requires State Plan Amendment (SPA) submissions to be reviewed by the D.C. Council prior to submission to CMS. DHCF receives comments from the Executive Office of the Mayor on any corresponding rulemakings and incorporates any required changes based on those comments into the SPAs.

PRA Disclosure Statement: Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) collects this mandatory information in accordance with (42 U.S.C. 1396a) and (42 CFR 430.12); which sets forth the authority for the submittal and collection of state plans and plan amendment information in a format defined by CMS for the purpose of improving the state application and federal review processes, improve federal program management of Medicaid programs and Children's Health Insurance Program, and to standardize Medicaid program data which covers basic requirements, and individualized content that reflects the characteristics of the particular state's program. The information will be used to monitor and analyze performance metrics related to the Medicaid and Children's Health Insurance Program in efforts to boost program integrity efforts, improve performance and accountability across the programs. Under the Privacy Act of 1974 any personally identifying information obtained will be kept private to the extent of the law. According to the Paperwork Reduction Act of 1995, no persons are required to respond to a collection of information unless it displays a valid OMB control number. The valid OMB control number for this information collection is 0938-1188. The time required to complete this information collection is estimated to range from 1 hour to 80 hours per response (see below), including the time to review instructions, search existing data resources, gather the data needed, and complete and review the information collection. If you have comments concerning the accuracy of the time estimate(s) or suggestions for improving this form, please write to: CMS, 7500 Security Boulevard, Attn: PRA Reports Clearance Officer, Mail Stop C4-26-05, Baltimore, Maryland 21244-1850.

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DC - Submission Package - DC2025MS0003O - (DC-25-0013) - Eligibility

Medicaid State Plan Eligibility

Mandatory Eligibility Groups

MEDICAID | Medicaid State Plan | Eligibility | DC2025MS0003O | DC-25-0013

CMS-10434 OMB 0938-1188

Package Header

Package ID	DC2025MS0003O	SPA ID	DC-25-0013
Submission Type	Official	Initial Submission Date	8/21/2025
Approval Date	11/18/2025	Effective Date	1/1/2026
Superseded SPA ID	DC-23-0002		
	System-Derived		

Mandatory Coverage

A. The state provides Medicaid to mandatory groups of individuals. The mandatory groups covered are:

Families and Adults

Eligibility Group Name		Covered In State Plan	Include RU In Package	Included in Another Submission Package	Source Type
Infants and Children under Age 19		☒	☐	☐	CONVERTED
Parents and Other Caretaker Relatives		☒	☒	☐	APPROVED
Pregnant Women		☒	☐	☐	CONVERTED
Deemed Newborns		☒	☐	☐	NEW
Children with Title IV-E Adoption Assistance, Foster Care or Guardianship Care		☒	☐	☐	NEW
Former Foster Care Children		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED
Transitional Medical Assistance		☒	☐	☐	NEW
Extended Medicaid due to Spousal Support Collections		☒	☐	☐	NEW

Aged, Blind and Disabled

Eligibility Group Name		Covered In State Plan	Include RU In Package	Included in Another Submission Package	Source Type
SSI Beneficiaries		☒	☐	☒	APPROVED
Closed Eligibility Groups		☒	☐	☐	NEW
Individuals Deemed To Be Receiving SSI		☒	☐	☐	NEW

Eligibility Group Name		Covered In State Plan	Include RU In Package 	Included in Another Submission Package	Source Type 
Working Individuals under 1619(b)		☒	☐	☐	NEW
Qualified Medicare Beneficiaries		☒	☐	☐	NEW
Qualified Disabled and Working Individuals		☒	☐	☐	NEW
Specified Low Income Medicare Beneficiaries		☒	☐	☐	NEW
Qualifying Individuals		☒	☐	☐	NEW

Mandatory Eligibility Groups

MEDICAID | Medicaid State Plan | Eligibility | DC2025MS0003O | DC-25-0013

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System-Derived			

B. The state elects the Adult Group, described at 42 CFR 435.119.

☒ Yes ☐ No

Families and Adults

Eligibility Group Name		Covered In State Plan	Include RU In Package ?	Included in Another Submission Package	Source Type ?
Adult Group		☒	☐	☒	APPROVED

C. Additional Information (optional)

Eligibility Groups Deselected from Coverage

The following eligibility groups were previously covered in the source approved version of the state plan and deselected from coverage as part of this submission package:

- N/A

PRA Disclosure Statement: Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) collects this mandatory information in accordance with (42 U.S.C. 1396a) and (42 CFR 430.12); which sets forth the authority for the submittal and collection of state plans and plan amendment information in a format defined by CMS for the purpose of improving the state application and federal review processes, improve federal program management of Medicaid programs and Children's Health Insurance Program, and to standardize Medicaid program data which covers basic requirements, and individualized content that reflects the characteristics of the particular state's program. The information will be used to monitor and analyze performance metrics related to the Medicaid and Children's Health Insurance Program in efforts to boost program integrity efforts, improve performance and accountability across the programs. Under the Privacy Act of 1974 any personally identifying information obtained will be kept private to the extent of the law. According to the Paperwork Reduction Act of 1995, no persons are required to respond to a collection of information unless it displays a valid OMB control number. The valid OMB control number for this information collection is 0938-1188. The time required to complete this information collection is estimated to range from 1 hour to 80 hours per response (see below), including the time to review instructions, search existing data resources, gather the data needed, and complete and review the information collection. If you have comments concerning the accuracy of the time estimate(s) or suggestions for improving this form, please write to: CMS, 7500 Security Boulevard, Attn: PRA Reports Clearance Officer, Mail Stop C4-26-05, Baltimore, Maryland 21244-1850.

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DC - Submission Package - DC2025MS0003O - (DC-25-0013) - Eligibility

Medicaid State Plan Eligibility

Eligibility Groups - Mandatory Coverage

Parents and Other Caretaker Relatives

MEDICAID | Medicaid State Plan | Eligibility | DC2025MS0003O | DC-25-0013

Parents and other caretaker relatives of dependent children with household income at or below a standard established by the state.

CMS-10434 OMB 0938-1188

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Approval Date	11/18/2025	Effective Date	1/1/2026
Superseded SPA ID	DC-13-0007		
	User-Entered		

The state covers the mandatory parents and other caretaker relatives group in accordance with the following provisions:

A. Characteristics

Individuals qualifying under this eligibility group must meet the following criteria:

1. Are parents or other caretaker relatives (defined at 42 CFR 435.4), including pregnant women, of dependent children (defined at 42 CFR 435.4) under age 18. Spouses of parents and other caretaker relatives are also included.

The state elects the following options:

- ☒ a. This eligibility group includes individuals who are parents or other caretakers of children who are 18 years old, provided the children are full-time students in a secondary school or the equivalent level of vocational or technical training.
- ☒ b. Options relating to the definition of caretaker relative:

- ☐ i. The definition of caretaker relative includes the domestic partner of the parent or other caretaker relative, even after the partnership is terminated.
- ☒ ii. The definition of caretaker relative includes other relatives of the child based on blood (including those of half-blood), adoption or marriage.

Description of other relatives:

All individuals related to the child by blood, marriage, or adoption. An individual related to the child through marriage can continue to be considered a caretaker relative even if the relationship ended due to divorce or other legal termination of the relationship.

- ☐ iii. The definition of caretaker relative includes any adult with whom the child is living and who assumes primary responsibility for the dependent child's care.

- ☒ c. Options relating to the definition of dependent child:
- ☒ i. The state elects to eliminate the requirement that a dependent child must be deprived of parental support or care by reason of the death, physical or mental incapacity, or absence from the home or unemployment of at least one parent.

☐ ii. The child must be deprived of parental support or care, but a less restrictive standard is used to measure unemployment of the parent (select the one that applies):

2. Have household income at or below the standard established by the state.

Parents and Other Caretaker Relatives

MEDICAID | Medicaid State Plan | Eligibility | DC2025MS0003O | DC-25-0013

Package Header

Package ID	DC2025MS0003O	SPA ID	DC-25-0013
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Approval Date	11/18/2025	Effective Date	1/1/2026
Superseded SPA ID	DC-13-0007		
User-Entered			

B. Financial Methodologies

MAGI-based methodologies are used in calculating household income. Please refer as necessary to MAGI-Based Methodologies, completed by the state.

C. Income Standard Used

1. The income standard for this group is based on a percentage of the federal poverty level.

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No

2. The state uses the following income standard for this group:

FPL 133.00%

Parents and Other Caretaker Relatives

MEDICAID | Medicaid State Plan | Eligibility | DC2025MS00030 | DC-25-0013

Package Header

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Approval Date	11/18/2025	Effective Date	1/1/2026
Superseded SPA ID	DC-13-0007		
User-Entered			

D. Basis for Income Standard

1. Minimum Income Standard

a. The minimum income standard used for this group is the state's AFDC payment standard in effect as of May 1, 1988, converted to MAGI-equivalent amounts by household size. The standard is described in AFDC Income Standards.

☒ b. The state certifies that it has submitted and received approval for its converted May 1, 1988 AFDC payment standard.

2. Maximum income standard

☒ a. The state certifies that it has submitted and received approval for its converted income standard(s) for parents and other caretaker relatives to MAGI-equivalent standards and the determination of the maximum income standard to be used for parents and other caretaker relatives under this eligibility group.

b. The state's maximum income standard for this eligibility group is:

- ☐ i. The state's effective income level for section 1931 families under the Medicaid state plan as of March 23, 2010, converted to a MAGI-equivalent percent of FPL or amounts by household size.
- ☐ ii. The state's effective income level for section 1931 families under the Medicaid state plan as of December 31, 2013, converted to a MAGI-equivalent percent of FPL or amounts by household size.
- ☐ iii. The state's effective income level for any population of parents/caretaker relatives under a Medicaid 1115 demonstration as of March 23, 2010, converted to a MAGI-equivalent percent of FPL or amounts by household size.
- ☐ iv. The state's effective income level for any population of parents/caretaker relatives under a Medicaid 1115 demonstration as of December 31, 2013, converted to a MAGI-equivalent percent of FPL or amounts by household size.

c. The amount of the maximum income standard is:

- ☐ i. A percentage of the federal poverty level: 216.00%
- ☐ ii. The state's AFDC payment standard in effect as of July 16, 1996, converted to a MAGI-equivalent standard. The standard is described in AFDC Income Standards.
- ☐ iii. The state's AFDC payment standard in effect as of July 16, 1996, increased by no more than the percentage increase in the Consumer Price Index for urban consumers (CPI-U) since such date, converted to a MAGI-equivalent standard. The standard is described in AFDC Income Standards.
- ☐ iv. The state's TANF payment standard, converted to a MAGI-equivalent standard. The standard is described in AFDC Income Standards.
- ☐ v. Other dollar amount

Parents and Other Caretaker Relatives

MEDICAID | Medicaid State Plan | Eligibility | DC2025MS0003O | DC-25-0013

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E. Additional Information (optional)

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DC - Submission Package - DC2025MS0003O - (DC-25-0013) - Eligibility

Medicaid State Plan Eligibility

Optional Eligibility Groups

MEDICAID | Medicaid State Plan | Eligibility | DC2025MS0003O | DC-25-0013

CMS-10434 OMB 0938-1188

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System-Derived			

A. Options for Coverage

The state provides Medicaid to specified optional groups of individuals.

☒ Yes ☐ No

The optional eligibility groups covered in the state plan are (elections made in this screen may not be comprehensive during the transition period from the paper-based state plan to MACPro):

Families and Adults

Eligibility Group Name		Covered In State Plan	Include RU In Package	Included in Another Submission Package	Source Type
Optional Coverage of Parents and Other Caretaker Relatives		☐	☐	☐	NEW
Reasonable Classifications of Individuals under Age 21		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED
Children with Non-IV-E Adoption Assistance		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED
Independent Foster Care Adolescents		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED
Optional Targeted Low Income Children		☐	☐	☐	NEW
Individuals above 133% FPL under Age 65		☐	☐	☒	NEW
Individuals Needing Treatment for Breast or Cervical Cancer		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED
Individuals Eligible for Family Planning Services		☐	☐	☐	NEW
Individuals with Tuberculosis		☐	☐	☐	NEW
Individuals Electing COBRA Continuation Coverage		☐	☐	☐	NEW

Aged, Blind and Disabled

Eligibility Group Name		Covered In State Plan	Include RU In Package ?	Included in Another Submission Package	Source Type ?
Individuals Eligible for but Not Receiving Cash Assistance		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED
Individuals Eligible for Cash Except for Institutionalization		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED
Individuals Receiving Home and Community-Based Waiver Services under Institutional Rules		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED
Optional State Supplement Beneficiaries		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED
Individuals in Institutions Eligible under a Special Income Level		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED
PACE Participants		☒	☐	☒	APPROVED
Individuals Receiving Hospice		☐	☐	☐	NEW
Children under Age 19 with a Disability		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED
Age and Disability-Related Poverty Level		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED
Work Incentives		☐	☐	☐	NEW
Ticket to Work Basic		☐	☐	☐	NEW
Ticket to Work Medical Improvements		☐	☐	☐	NEW
Family Opportunity Act Children with a Disability		☐	☐	☐	NEW
Individuals Receiving State Plan Home and Community-Based Services		☐	☐	☐	NEW
Individuals Receiving State Plan Home and Community-Based Services Who Are Otherwise Eligible for HCBS Waivers		☐	☐	☐	NEW

Optional Eligibility Groups

MEDICAID | Medicaid State Plan | Eligibility | DC2025MS00030 | DC-25-0013

Package Header

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System-Derived			

B. Medically Needy Options for Coverage

The state provides Medicaid to specified groups of individuals who are medically needy.

☒ Yes ☐ No

The medically needy eligibility groups covered in the state plan are:

1. Mandatory Medically Needy:

Families and Adults

Eligibility Group Name		Covered In State Plan	Include RU In Package ?	Included in Another Submission Package	Source Type ?
Medically Needy Pregnant Women		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED
Medically Needy Children under Age 18		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED

Aged, Blind and Disabled

Eligibility Group Name		Covered In State Plan	Include RU In Package ?	Included in Another Submission Package	Source Type ?
Protected Medically Needy Individuals Who Were Eligible in 1973		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED

2. Optional Medically Needy:

Families and Adults

Eligibility Group Name		Covered In State Plan	Include RU In Package ?	Included in Another Submission Package	Source Type ?
Medically Needy Reasonable Classifications of Individuals under Age 21		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED
Medically Needy Parents and Other Caretaker Relatives		☒	☐	☐	APPROVED

Aged, Blind and Disabled

Eligibility Group Name		Covered In State Plan	Include RU In Package ?	Included in Another Submission Package	Source Type ?
Medically Needy Populations Based on Age, Blindness or Disability		☒	☐	☒	APPROVED

Optional Eligibility Groups

MEDICAID | Medicaid State Plan | Eligibility | DC2025MS0003O | DC-25-0013

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	System-Derived		

C. Additional Information (optional)

Eligibility Groups Deselected from Coverage

The following eligibility groups were previously covered in the source approved version of the state plan and deselected from coverage as part of this submission package:

- Individuals above 133% FPL under Age 65

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Medicaid State Plan Eligibility

Eligibility Groups - Options for Coverage

Individuals above 133% FPL under Age 65

MEDICAID | Medicaid State Plan | Eligibility | DC2025MS0003O | DC-25-0013

Individuals under 65, not otherwise mandatorily or optionally eligible, with income above 133% FPL and at or below a standard established by the state.

CMS-10434 OMB 0938-1188

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Group No Longer Covered

Covered Through	12/31/2025	Terminated As Of	1/1/2026
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